FROM FOREIGN OFFICE TO WASHINGTON

[This telegram is of particular secrecy and should be retained by the addressed recipient and not passed on.]

FOREIGN OFFICE AND
WHITEHALL, 16th DECEMBER

Cypher/OTP

No. 6119
16th December, 1951. D. 2.05 a.m. 16th December, 1951.

IMMEDIATE
SECRET

Addressed to Washington telegram No. 6119 of 16th December. Repeated for information to Tokyo.

My telegram No. 1436 to Tokyo [of 14th December: Japanese relations with Formosa.]

Dening's reports show that there is a wide divergence between our views and those of Mr. Dulles, and that Dulles has apparently spoken sufficiently strongly to the Japanese to evoke an official statement in the press (see Tokyo telegram No. 1771 [of 14th December]). I do not like this development. You should therefore see Mr. Acheson as soon as possible and discuss the problem on the following lines:

(a) Mr. Acheson's letter to me of 22nd November (copied to you) stressed the importance of preventing the Japanese playing one Government off against each other over this question, and suggested that if difficulties arose in the Tokyo talks we should communicate with each other.

(b) I understand that Dulles intends to press the Japanese to sign a "peace treaty" with the "Nationalist Government of the Republic of China" whose writ will be confined to the territory now administered by Chiang Kai-shek. I am afraid that such a treaty, even limited in this way, would be evidence that Japan recognised the Nationalist régime as the Government entitled to act for the whole China and Japan. Such a treaty would prejudice Japan's future relations with mainland China.

/(c) By insisting

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(c) By insisting on a "peace treaty" (a state of war can be ended in other ways) the United States Government goes far to assume responsibility for determining Japan's relations with China. In June this year Dulles appeared convinced that none of the Allies should undertake this responsibility.

(d) The Japanese have already in effect stated (Tokyo telegram No. 1771) that their action in sending Iwakai to Formosa is due to United States pressure.

(e) This question affects Japan's relations with China, and with the West. We should not give the Japanese a pretext for pinning the blame for any difficulties they may encounter with mainland China on the Western Powers.

(f) Last June Mr. Dulles and Mr. Morrison agreed (see Intel. No. 144 of June 26th) that Japan's future attitude towards China must necessarily be for determination by Japan itself in the exercise of the sovereign and independent status contemplated by the Treaty. The Treaty was framed so as not to prejudice that principle. In his letter of November 22nd to me Mr. Acheson said that there was no thought of attempting to coerce the Japanese Government.

(g) The action now apparently contemplated by the United States Administration seems to me hard to reconcile with these statements of policy. I cannot forecast the possible reactions in Japan to the press statement reported in Tokyo telegram No. [redacted] but surely it will appear to [redacted] as a [redacted] derogation from the status which they will acquire when the Treaty comes into force and they are able to determine their foreign policy for themselves.

2. I hope you will be able to persuade Mr. Acheson not (repeat not) to press the Japanese to take any action with regard to Formosa before the Peace Treaty comes into force. After the

/Peace Treaty

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Foreign Office telegram No. 619 to Washington

3.

Peace Treaty has come into force I would think it reasonable that the Japanese might without unduly haste seek to regularise matters connected with trade, claims and other "establishment" matters. If however Japan is to be pressed now to commit herself to make peace with Formosa once she is free to do so the common front which our two Governments have carefully maintained towards the Japanese will be weakened.

3. For your own information. Apart from my dislike of the substance of Mr. Dulles's proposals, American tactics in this matter make no sense. It seems to be another example of their weakness for pursuing a temporary domestic political objective (in this case to placate the Republican Senators) regardless of longer term consequences in the international field.

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